FOREIGN TRADE, WTO, FTAS AND PROTECTIONISM

TRADE TRANSMISSION RAIL → TRADE-ACCOUNT BOUNDARY → WTO NON-DISCRIMINATION MAP → TARIFF SPACE LADDER → FTA STATUS AND ORIGIN → CREATION VERSUS DIVERSION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◇ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00 → STAGE 00

TRADE TRANSMISSION RAIL

TRADE TRANSMISSION RAIL | BORDER RULE | LANDED PRICE + MARKET ACCESS | SOURCING + INVESTMENT | OUTPUT + JOBS + CONSUMERS | MUST REMEMBER | TRADE POLICY COMBINES TARIFFS, NON-TARIFF MEASURES, SERVICES, RULES OF

BORDER RULE → LANDED PRICE + MARKET ACCESS → SOURCING + INVESTMENT → OUTPUT + JOBS + CONSUMERS → MUST REMEMBER: Trade policy combines tariffs, non-tariff measures, services, rules of

CORE CLAIM
- BORDER RULE
- LANDED PRICE + MARKET ACCESS

MECHANISM
- SOURCING + INVESTMENT
- OUTPUT + JOBS + CONSUMERS

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Trade policy combines tariffs, non-tariff measures, services, rules of...
- BORDER RULE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Trade policy combines tariffs, non-tariff measures, services, rules of.

01 → STAGE 01

TRADE-ACCOUNT BOUNDARY

TRADE-ACCOUNT BOUNDARY | GOODS CROSSING BORDERS | MODE-SPECIFIC SUPPLY | TOTAL TRADE | STATE INCLUDED COMPONENTS | CURRENT ACCOUNT | BROADER THAN TRADE BALANCE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
MERCHANDISE → goods crossing borders	TOTAL TRADE → state included components	MERCHANDISE → goods crossing borders
SERVICES → mode-specific supply	CURRENT ACCOUNT → broader than trade balance	SERVICES → mode-specific supply

CORE CLAIM
- MERCHANDISE → goods crossing borders
- SERVICES → mode-specific supply

MECHANISM
- TOTAL TRADE → state included components
- CURRENT ACCOUNT → broader than trade balance

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MERCHANDISE → goods crossing borders
- SERVICES → mode-specific supply

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TOTAL TRADE → state included components; CURRENT ACCOUNT → broader than trade balance.

02 → STAGE 02

WTO NON-DISCRIMINATION MAP

WTO NON-DISCRIMINATION MAP | TREATMENT ACROSS TRADING PARTNERS | NATIONAL TREATMENT | INTERNAL TREATMENT AFTER ENTRY | AGREEMENT-SPECIFIC CONDITIONS | CUSTOMS DUTY | BORDER STAGE

MFN → treatment across trading partners

NATIONAL TREATMENT → internal treatment after entry → EXCEPTIONS → agreement-specific conditions → CUSTOMS DUTY → border stage

CORE CLAIM
- MFN → treatment across trading partners
- NATIONAL TREATMENT → internal treatment after entry

MECHANISM
- EXCEPTIONS → agreement-specific conditions
- CUSTOMS DUTY → border stage

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MFN → treatment across trading partners
- NATIONAL TREATMENT → internal treatment after entry

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXCEPTIONS → agreement-specific conditions; CUSTOMS DUTY → border stage.

03 → STAGE 03

TARIFF SPACE LADDER

TARIFF SPACE LADDER | BOUND RATE | NEGOTIATED CEILING | APPLIED RATE | RATE ACTUALLY CHARGED | GAP BETWEEN THE TWO | PRESERVE SCHEDULE + DATE

BOUND RATE → negotiated ceiling

APPLIED RATE → rate actually charged → WATER → gap between the two → CHANGE → preserve schedule + date

CORE CLAIM
- BOUND RATE → negotiated ceiling
- APPLIED RATE → rate actually charged

MECHANISM
- WATER → gap between the two
- CHANGE → preserve schedule + date

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BOUND RATE → negotiated ceiling
- APPLIED RATE → rate actually charged

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WATER → gap between the two; CHANGE → preserve schedule + date.

04 → STAGE 04

FTA STATUS AND ORIGIN CHAIN

FTA STATUS AND ORIGIN CHAIN | ENTERED INTO FORCE | PRODUCT COVERAGE + PHASE-DOWN | RULES OF ORIGIN | PREFERENCE ELIGIBILITY

NEGOTIATING → SIGNED → RATIFIED → ENTERED INTO FORCE → PRODUCT COVERAGE + PHASE-DOWN → RULES OF ORIGIN → preference eligibility

CORE CLAIM
- NEGOTIATING → SIGNED → RATIFIED
- ENTERED INTO FORCE

MECHANISM
- PRODUCT COVERAGE + PHASE-DOWN
- RULES OF ORIGIN → preference eligibility

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- NEGOTIATING → SIGNED → RATIFIED
- ENTERED INTO FORCE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PRODUCT COVERAGE + PHASE-DOWN; RULES OF ORIGIN → preference eligibility.

05 → STAGE 05

CREATION VERSUS DIVERSION

CREATION VERSUS DIVERSION | TRADE CREATION | LOWER-COST PARTNER REPLACES DOMESTIC SUPPLY | TRADE DIVERSION | PREFERRED PARTNER DISPLACES CHEAPER OUTSIDER | WELFARE + PRODUCTIVITY | DO NOT INFER FROM GROSS TRADE ALONE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
TRADE CREATION → lower-cost partner replaces domestic supply	TEST → welfare + productivity	TRADE CREATION → lower-cost partner replaces domestic supply
TRADE DIVERSION → preferred partner displaces cheaper outsider	DO NOT infer from gross trade alone	TRADE DIVERSION → preferred partner displaces cheaper outsider

CORE CLAIM
- TRADE CREATION → lower-cost partner replaces domestic supply
- TRADE DIVERSION → preferred partner displaces cheaper outsider

MECHANISM
- TEST → welfare + productivity
- DO NOT infer from gross trade alone

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- TRADE CREATION → lower-cost partner replaces domestic supply
- TRADE DIVERSION → preferred partner displaces cheaper outsider

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRADE DIVERSION → preferred partner displaces cheaper outsider.

06 → STAGE 06

TRADE-REMEDY DECISION TREE

TRADE-REMEDY DECISION TREE | DUMPING + INJURY | ANTI-DUMPING ROUTE | SUBSIDY + INJURY | COUNTERVAILING ROUTE | IMPORT SURGE + SERIOUS INJURY | DGTR FINDING | NOT FINAL DUTY

DUMPING + INJURY → anti-dumping route

SUBSIDY + INJURY → countervailing route → IMPORT SURGE + SERIOUS INJURY → safeguard → DGTR FINDING → not final duty

CORE CLAIM
- DUMPING + INJURY → anti-dumping route
- SUBSIDY + INJURY → countervailing route

MECHANISM
- IMPORT SURGE + SERIOUS INJURY → safeguard
- DGTR FINDING → not final duty

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DUMPING + INJURY → anti-dumping route
- SUBSIDY + INJURY → countervailing route

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: IMPORT SURGE + SERIOUS INJURY → safeguard; DGTR FINDING → not final duty.

07 → STAGE 07

TRIMS AND TRIPS BOUNDARY

TRIMS AND TRIPS BOUNDARY | GOODS-LINKED INVESTMENT MEASURES | MINIMUM IP STANDARDS | SERVICES RULES | DOMESTIC LAW | GRANT + ENFORCEMENT

TRIMS → goods-linked investment measures

TRIPS → minimum IP standards → GATS → services rules → DOMESTIC LAW → grant + enforcement

CORE CLAIM
- TRIMS → goods-linked investment measures
- TRIPS → minimum IP standards

MECHANISM
- GATS → services rules
- DOMESTIC LAW → grant + enforcement

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- TRIMS → goods-linked investment measures
- TRIPS → minimum IP standards

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GATS → services rules; DOMESTIC LAW → grant + enforcement.

08 → STAGE 08

IGC OBJECTIVE TRAP

IGC OBJECTIVE TRAP | INTERGOVERNMENTAL GRAIN-TRADE BODY | MARKET INFORMATION + COOPERATION | NOT UN RELIEF AGENCY | NOT FCI PROCUREMENT OR PRICE SETTING

CORE CLAIM
- INTERGOVERNMENTAL GRAIN-TRADE BODY
- MARKET INFORMATION + COOPERATION

MECHANISM
- NOT UN RELIEF AGENCY
- NOT FCI PROCUREMENT OR PRICE SETTING

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- INTERGOVERNMENTAL GRAIN-TRADE BODY
- MARKET INFORMATION + COOPERATION

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NOT UN RELIEF AGENCY; NOT FCI PROCUREMENT OR PRICE SETTING.

09 → STAGE 09

PROTECTION COST CASCADE

PROTECTION COST CASCADE | UPSTREAM TARIFF | INPUT COST | DOWNSTREAM EXPORT PRICE | COMPETITIVENESS + CONSUMER EFFECT | CLOSE DISTINCTION | FTA SIGNATURE IS NOT ENTRY INTO FORCE OR UTILISATION

UPSTREAM TARIFF → INPUT COST → DOWNSTREAM EXPORT PRICE → COMPETITIVENESS + CONSUMER EFFECT → CLOSE DISTINCTION: FTA signature is not entry into force or utilisation, tariff binding

CORE CLAIM
- UPSTREAM TARIFF
- INPUT COST

MECHANISM
- DOWNSTREAM EXPORT PRICE
- COMPETITIVENESS + CONSUMER EFFECT

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: FTA signature is not entry into force or utilisation, tariff binding...
- UPSTREAM TARIFF

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: FTA signature is not entry into force or utilisation, tariff binding.

10 → STAGE 10

WTO DISPUTE-SETTLEMENT STATUS

WTO DISPUTE-SETTLEMENT STATUS | PANELS CONTINUE | APPELLATE BODY | NO NEW APPEALS SINCE DEC 2019 | NOTIFIED APPEALS ACCUMULATE | WEAKENED SYSTEM | NO SYSTEM | EVIDENCE LIMIT

PANELS CONTINUE

APPELLATE BODY → no new appeals since Dec 2019 → NOTIFIED APPEALS ACCUMULATE → WEAKENED SYSTEM != NO SYSTEM

CORE CLAIM
- PANELS CONTINUE
- APPELLATE BODY → no new appeals since Dec 2019

MECHANISM
- NOTIFIED APPEALS ACCUMULATE
- WEAKENED SYSTEM != NO SYSTEM

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: FORMULA / STATUS / CAUSATION: Specify agreement parties, product/service...
- PANELS CONTINUE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: FORMULA / STATUS / CAUSATION: Specify agreement parties, product/service.

11 → STAGE 11

TRADE-POLICY ANSWER SPINE

TRADE-POLICY ANSWER SPINE | DEFINE LEGAL CATEGORY + STATUS | TRACE VALUE-CHAIN INCIDENCE | TEST CONSUMERS + FIRMS + WORKERS | CONCLUDE CAPABILITY + DIVERSIFICATION

DEFINE legal category + status → TRACE value-chain incidence → TEST consumers + firms + workers → CONCLUDE capability + diversification

CORE CLAIM
- DEFINE legal category + status
- TRACE value-chain incidence

MECHANISM
- TEST consumers + firms + workers
- CONCLUDE capability + diversification

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- DEFINE legal category + status
- TRACE value-chain incidence

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEST consumers + firms + workers; CONCLUDE capability + diversification.

E → EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | COMPARATIVE ADVANTAGE EXPLAINS GAINS FROM TRADE, WHILE STRATEGIC TRADE | EFFECTIVE PROTECTION CAN EXCEED THE NOMINAL TARIFF WHEN OUTPUT | GVC PARTICIPATION DEPENDS ON PREDICTABLE CUSTOMS, LOGISTICS, STANDARDS, IMPORTED | TRADE REMEDIES REQUIRE EVIDENCE OF INJURY AND CAUSAL LINKAGE | DIGITAL TRADE ADDS DATA, LOCALISATION, SOURCE-CODE, TAXATION AND PLATFORM-REGULATION | RESILIENCE POLICY SHOULD DIVERSIFY SUPPLIERS AND BUILD CAPABILITY RATHER | PROVIDES MULTILATERAL TRADE RULES, NEGOTIATION FORUMS AND DISPUTE-SETTLEMENT

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- CAUTION: Comparative advantage explains gains from trade, while strategic trade arguments focus
- CAUTION: Effective protection can exceed the nominal tariff when output protection combines with
- CAUTION: GVC participation depends on predictable customs, logistics, standards, imported inputs
- CAUTION: Trade remedies require evidence of injury and causal linkage under applicable rules.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- CAUTION: Digital trade adds data, localisation, source-code, taxation and platform-regulation
- CAUTION: Resilience policy should diversify suppliers and build capability rather than pursue
- WTO: provides multilateral trade rules, negotiation forums and dispute-settlement
- Department of Commerce: negotiates trade agreements and administers trade- policy

LEGACY / NUANCE
- DGTR: investigates specified trade-remedy cases under applicable law.
- Customs and standards or testing bodies: implement border treatment, origin
- CAUTION: A high tariff on an imported component can protect one upstream producer while making
- CAUTION: Rules of origin prevent goods from a non-member merely passing through an FTA partner

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels